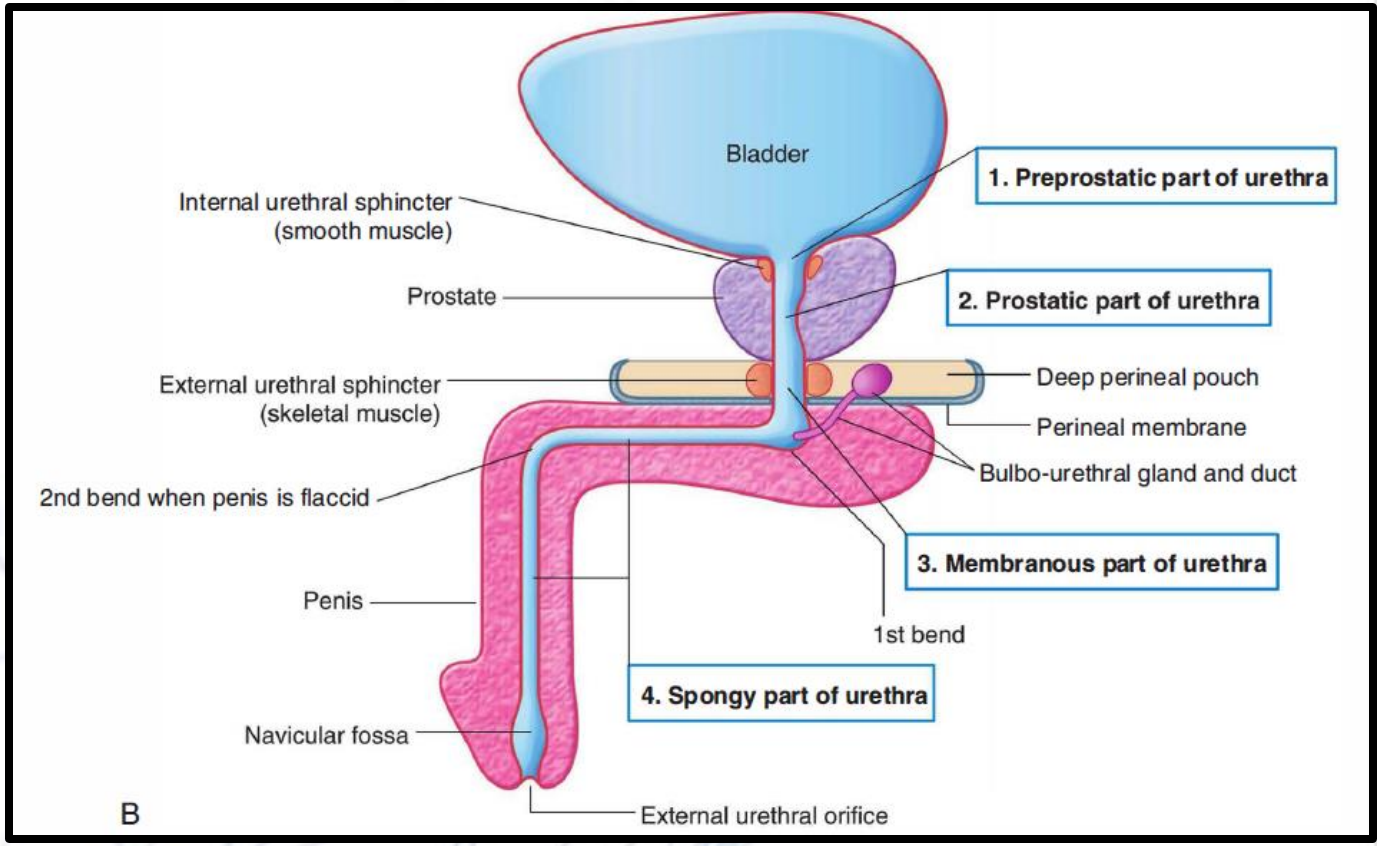
Urethra

- It is the duct that transmits urine from the urinary bladder outside the body.
- It arises from the lower end (neck) of the urinary bladder. It transmits urine and semen (in males).

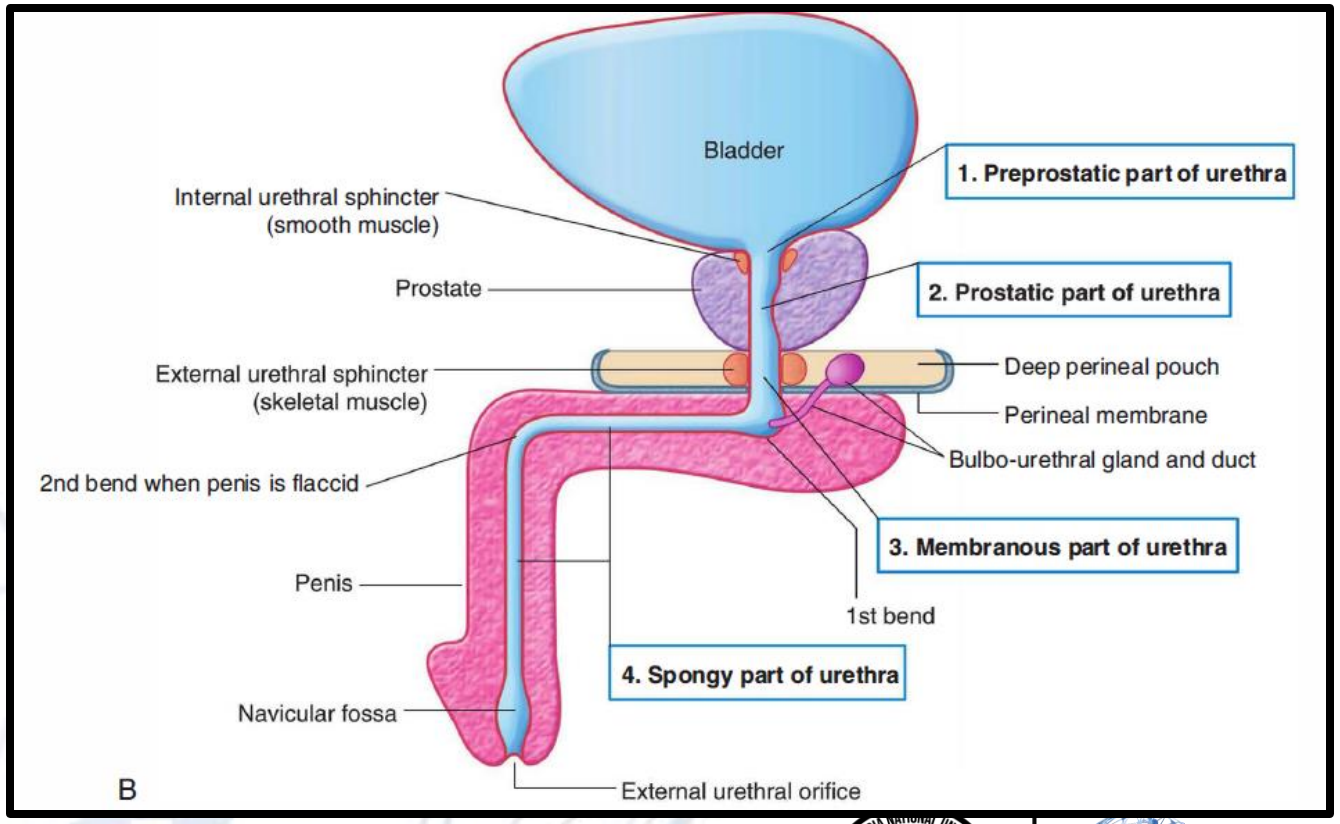


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Male Urethra

- It is about 20 cm long. It is longer than the female urethra and has 4 parts :

1- Intramural part : it lies within the lower end of the urinary bladder and is surrounded by the internal urethral sphincter.



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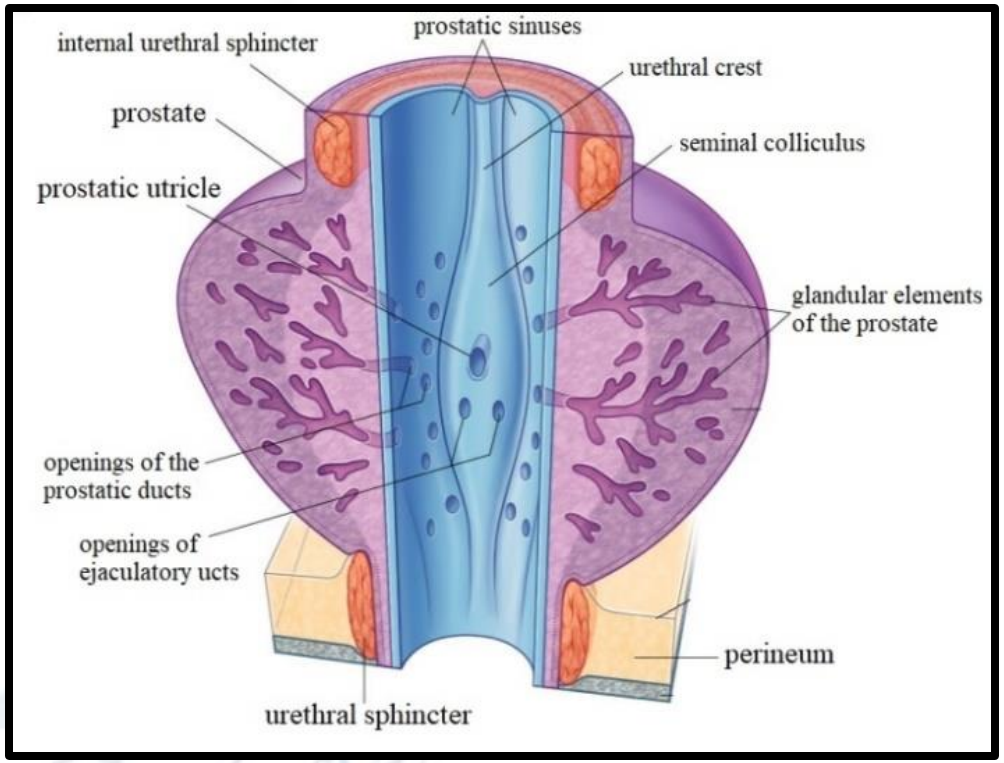
Male Urethra

2- Prostatic part : the ***widest and most dilatable part*** of the urethra. Its posterior wall shows:

Urethral crest: a midline longitudinal ridge.

Seminal colliculus: an elevation on the middle of the urethral crest.

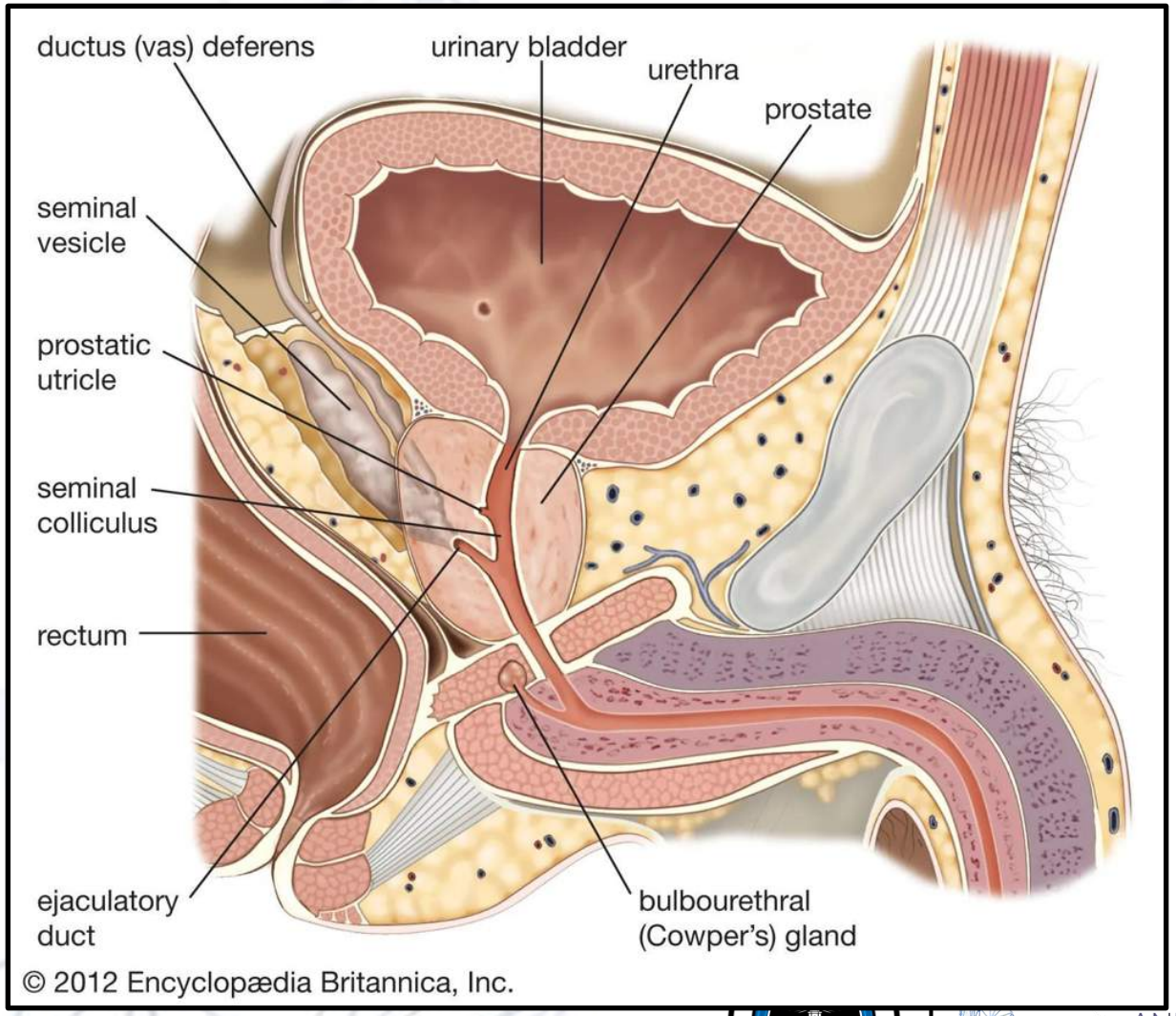
Prostatic sinus on each side of the crest where the prostatic ducts open.



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Male Urethra

Prostatic utricle (homologue of the uterus in women) is a blind pouch that opens in the center of the seminal colliculus. On each side of the utricle, an ejaculatory duct opens.

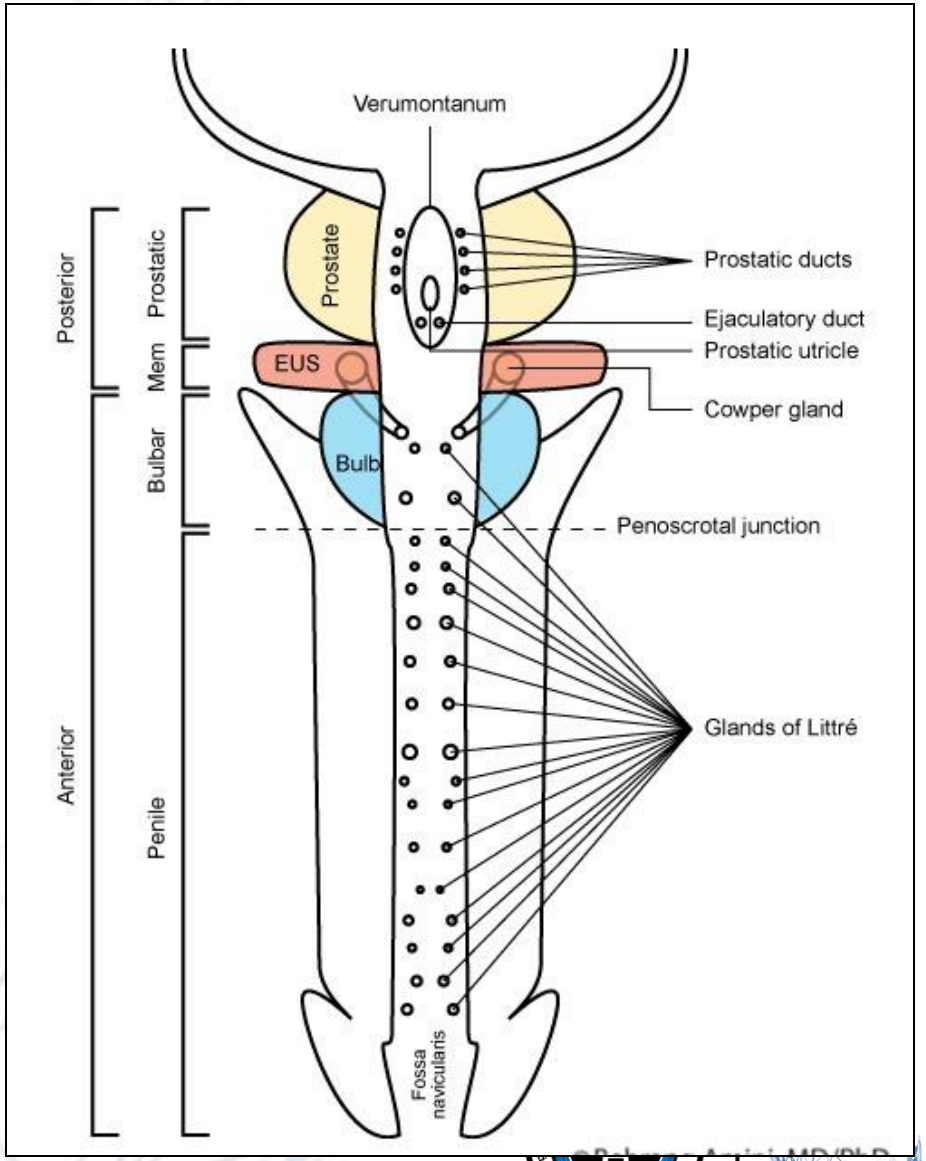


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Male Urethra

3- Membranous part : lies in the deep perineal pouch and is surrounded by the external urethral sphincter. It is the ***shortest*** and ***least dilatable*** part of the urethra.

4- Penile (spongy) part : the ***longest part*** of the urethra that passes through the bulb of the penis then the corpus spongiosum and ends at the ***external urethral meatus*** (narrowest point of the urethra). Before the external opening, it shows a dilatation called ***navicular fossa***. The ducts of the bulbourethral glands open in the penile urethra.



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